PRE-SEED · OCTOBER 2026

Quolin

Automated client checks for regulated firms that offer complex products.

Quolin onboards, classifies, assesses and limits every client, whether retail, accredited or institutional, then keeps them compliant and proves it to the regulator. Starting with digital-asset brokers in Asia-Pacific.

VOLODYMYR ROMANENKO · SU-LEE OEI · DANIEL FLEMING

THE PROBLEM

Client checks run on forms, spreadsheets and staff. They cost the same for £100 as for £1m.

9%

of UK adults got advice on pensions or investments in the past year. The FCA estimates about 23 million people are underserved.

A$4,668

median ongoing advice fee in Australia in 2025, up 67% in five years. Careful judgement is priced for the wealthy.

Accredited only

DBS limits its digital exchange and digital-asset options to accredited and institutional clients.

So firms turn smaller clients away, or run a tick-box that will not survive an inspection. Quolin automates the checks end to end.

Sources: FCA Financial Lives survey and targeted support statements, 2026; Adviser Ratings 2025 (survey); DBS.

WHO WE SELL TO

Regulated firms that let their own clients buy complex products.

FIRST

Licensed digital-asset brokers and trading platforms

About 38 licensees in Singapore, 13 licensed platforms in Hong Kong and 45+ firms applying in Australia. Small, nameable, and already under a duty.

NEXT

Banks, private banks, wealth platforms, external asset managers

Firms adding digital assets and other complex products for clients who already trust their name. Larger contracts, slower to buy.

Buyer

The head of compliance

Users

Compliance and onboarding teams

Their clients

Retail, accredited and institutional, each needing different checks

WHY BANKS HOLD BACK

Several barriers keep banks out. We remove the one that only software can.

BARRIER	WHAT IT MEANS	HOW IT IS SOLVED
Capital	Under Basel rules from January 2026, a bank holding bitcoin on its own balance sheet must hold capital equal to the full amount: a 1,250% risk weight, so £1 of capital for every £1 held	Offer digital assets as agent, not owner
Custody and money laundering	Safekeeping and anti-money-laundering controls	Licensed partners, available today
Client checks	Proving each client may buy each product, up to what limit, and showing it to the regulator	Quolin. Done by hand today

Source: BIS Basel Framework SCO60, in force 1 January 2026; the Basel Committee is reviewing targeted elements.

WHY NOW

Regulators now require these checks for every retail client, with dates attached.

19 Jun 2025

Singapore. Test each retail client's understanding of the risks before they trade digital assets.

In force

Hong Kong. Assess each retail client's knowledge and set a personal limit on how much they can hold.

9 Apr 2027

Australia. Digital-asset platforms come under financial-services licensing and conduct rules.

25 Oct 2027

United Kingdom. New digital-asset regime starts; firms are applying for authorisation now.

In the EU, MiCA requires suitability checks for digital-asset advice and portfolio management across 27 member states.

Sources: MAS Guidelines PS-G03; SFC VATP requirements; ASIC; FCA; EU Regulation 2023/1114.

HOW QUOLIN WORKS

Three steps, shown with one client.

Example. Mei, a retail client in Singapore, wants to buy bitcoin through her licensed broker. The broker sends Quolin her details and her test answers.

STEP 1 · ONBOARD

Classify and assess

Identifies Mei as a retail client, runs the risk test her regulator requires, and checks which country's rules apply.

STEP 2 · DECIDE

Allow, block or refer

Allows, blocks or sends her case to a person, with plain-English reasons and the maximum she may hold.

STEP 3 · KEEP COMPLIANT

Record, monitor, report

Records every decision so it can be replayed years later, re-checks Mei when rules change, and produces the regulator's reports.

The firm stays in charge: it signs off the rules and owns every client decision. Quolin never gives advice, holds assets or executes trades.

WHAT WE BUILD, BUY AND REFUSE

Build the decision and evidence core. Buy the commodity. Refuse what a bank cannot sign off.

Build

- Risk awareness and knowledge assessments, with integrity controls
- Client classification
- Decision engine and per-client limits
- Cross-border resolution
- Evidence store and replay
- Policy console with named sign-off
- Inspection packs and rule-change watch

Buy or partner

- Identity verification: Veriff, Sumsub or Onfido
- Behavioural risk profiling, e.g. Oxford Risk
- Consent-based open-banking data, later
- Trading and custody rails

Will not build

- Investment recommendations to end clients
- Web research on clients
- Credit-bureau data
- Webcam-proctored exams

FIRST PRODUCT

Singapore's Risk Awareness Assessment, automated.

Since June 2025, Singapore's regulator (MAS) has expected every licensed digital-asset firm to give each retail client a **Risk Awareness Assessment** before they trade: a test that checks they understand what they are buying. Firms run it mostly by hand today.

Already required

So firms have a budget and a real inspection risk

Narrow

So we can ship it in months, not years

Uses the whole engine

Onboarding, decision, record and report

Named buyers

About 38 licensed firms on a public list

To be confirmed by customers. Before we raise, we need written trial interest from compliance heads at three firms. If they need a different check first, we change the first product, not the engine.

PROOF OF BUILD

A working prototype, built to refuse to overstate itself.

4 packs

Illustrative rule packs for Singapore, Australia, Hong Kong and the EU, running end to end with cross-border resolution.

~1 : 1

Test-to-application code ratio. Independent AI code reviews; every finding fixed and re-verified.

3 taps

The demo: a block with reasons, an exact replay of a back-dated decision, a real governance PDF.

No pack is signed by a qualified reviewer yet, and the system will not let an unsigned pack reach a production tenant. The demo's history is fixture data, and we say so before you ask.

Machines build; accountable people sign. Funding the first signatures is the first line of this raise.

MARKET

A small, reachable beachhead. The venture case is the institutions behind it.

~38

Digital-payment-token licensees in Singapore, September 2026

13

Licensed virtual-asset trading platforms in Hong Kong, May 2026

45+

Digital-asset licence applications recorded by ASIC in Australia, September 2026

Wave 1 alone is worth roughly £4-10m a year at £40-100k per platform (our estimate). The venture case is Wave 2: banks, wealth platforms and external asset managers distributing digital-asset ETPs and other complex products, with the same engine applied beyond digital assets.

Sources: MAS register via third-party compilations (verify on the MAS directory); SFC register; ASIC statement of 2 September 2026.

COMPETITION

Others make advisers faster or sell trading rails. We have not found anyone selling the gate.

Advice optimisers

Saturn ($15m Series A, 2025), Aveni, AdvisoryAI, Timeline. They make human advisers faster.

Risk profilers

Oxford Risk, Dynamic Planner, FinaMetrica. They profile risk inside advice journeys. Partners for us.

Digital-asset rails

Bitpanda Enterprise, Coinbase Crypto-as-a-Service, Zerohash. Trading and custody. Channel partners.

Rules as code

Droit, now part of FIS (March 2026). Replayable regulation for trading desks. Proof of demand, and a threat.

Replay alone is not a moat. Ours is signed, maintained jurisdiction packs and evidence histories a licensee cannot easily move.

Competitor details from public announcements and vendor sites, September 2026. We state what we have not found, not that nothing exists.

BUSINESS MODEL

A licence per jurisdiction plus a fee per assessed client. Never a cut of trading.

Wave 1 · Licensed platforms

£30-60k a year platform fee, plus £0.50-2 per active assessed client

Wave 2 · Institutions

£150-400k annual contract value per jurisdiction

Why no revenue share: a gate paid per trade has an interest in saying yes. That undermines its independence, invites regulatory scrutiny and reads as distribution rather than tooling. The licensee's new revenue is its own; our fee stays flat.

All Quolin prices are hypotheses to test with design partners. Benchmarks: Oxford Risk £85 per adviser per month; Dynamic Planner £60-179; Veriff $0.80-1.89 per verification.

HOW WE SELL

Direct to heads of compliance. Singapore first, then Australia.

Pilot → eight weeks beside the firm's current process → live

We start from the public list of Singapore licensees and our own network. Later, trading-platform providers and compliance consultancies can resell Quolin.

PHASE 0

Singapore

Risk Awareness Assessment, client classification, inspection reports. First paying firms.

PHASE 1

Australia

Checks for the new Act; test integrity controls.

PHASE 2

Hong Kong and banks

Personal holding limits; checks for banks' complex products.

PHASE 3

UK and EU

Rules for the FCA regime and MiCA; consent-based bank data.

TEAM

Product velocity, institutional access, markets engineering.

Volodymyr Romanenko

CO-FOUNDER · PRODUCT & STRATEGY

Originated the concept; owns product, regulatory research and the specification behind the build, and wrote the first prototype. Investment Management Certificate (CFA UK). Music scholar at Eton College; Risman Scholar at the Royal College of Music.

Su-Lee Oei

CO-FOUNDER · FINANCE, GOVERNANCE & INSTITUTIONAL STRATEGY

Three decades in institutional finance across Asia-Pacific. CA ANZ, GAICD, Qualified Risk Director. Capital strategy, governance, and the senior relationships behind Wave 2.

Daniel Fleming

TECHNICAL LEAD

Financial-markets software engineer: production risk, reconciliation and analytics systems. Python, Go, TypeScript; AWS, Docker, Kubernetes. Leads the production build from Sydney.

All three part-time today; Daniel full-time from January 2027, Volodymyr from July 2027. Qualified specialists write and sign each jurisdiction pack.

THE ASK

£800,000 to launch in Singapore and prepare Australia.

Use of funds, 18 months

Founders, £25-30k a year each	£136k
Engineering, two senior engineers	£218k
Legal and signed rules, SG and AU	£124k
Security and assurance, SOC 2 Type II	£71k
Company, payroll, travel, cloud	£90k
Contingency, 10%	£64k
Runway buffer, about 2.5 months	£97k

What the money must produce

Before close	Written trial interest from three regulated firms
Month 3	Singapore legal opinion; signed assessment
Month 6	First paying Singapore firm live
Month 12	SOC 2 Type II report; Australian rules signed
Month 18	Two or three paying firms; first bank in a pilot

Hong Kong, the UK and the EU are seed-round work. Equity terms open for discussion.

RISKS

Hard questions, answered before you ask.

QUESTION	ANSWER
Who is liable if a decision is wrong?	The licensee stays the regulated decision-maker. Our liability is contractual and insured, and replay makes any error traceable.
Will regulators accept automated gating?	They already supervise it: MAS digital-advisory guidelines since 2018, ESMA guidance on suitability algorithms. Deterministic rules with reasons and human referral are what they ask for.
Does this make Quolin an adviser?	Not if the licensee owns every policy and every client output. Singapore and Australian perimeter opinions are the first legal spend.
Why won't FIS, Avaloq or Temenos build it?	A market of about 38 Singapore licensees is below their threshold today. If one moves later, it is also our likely exit.
Isn't Wave 1 too small?	As a ceiling, yes. It pays for signed packs, which are what banks buy in Wave 2.

THANK YOU

Quolin

Not the same products for everyone. The same care.

Volodymyr Romanenko · voroman.work@gmail.com · +44 7733 404020

Data room on request: research brief, competitor map, code reviews and the live demo.